

LATE NITE HAPPY HOUR BOWLING LEAGUE

2025-2026

Constitution and By-Laws
(Revised August 2025)

Article 1 - Schedule:

- a. The Late Happy Hour Bowling League shall be sanctioned with USBC through its local association. The league shall consist of 13 teams with a playing strength of four (4) bowlers. The League will bowl Thursday night for thirty-two (32) weeks, commencing on the first Thursday after Labor Day in September. All scheduled matches will start practice at 8:20 pm and matches at 8:30 PM - **no earlier.**
- b. The League will bowl two (2) halves.
- c. ~~There will be a total of four (4) position matches (I.e. knockdowns); two (2) in each half (weeks 7 & 13)~~

Article 2 - Management:

The management of the League shall be vested in the Board of Directors, which shall consist of the Officers (President, Vice-President, and Secretary/Treasurer) and Team Captains. The Team Captains shall elect the Officers, and the Board shall adopt the League rules. A majority shall constitute a quorum.

Article 3 - Fees:

- a. The amount to be paid by each bowler each night shall be **\$25.00**, of which **\$13.50** will cover the cost of bowling, with the balance to be placed in the League Treasury.
- b. Team fees are to be hand delivered to the Secretary/Treasurer prior to the start of the second game.
- c. All games that a team bowls the weeks their team is more than **\$300.00** behind in bowling fees will be declared a forfeit.

Article 4 - Salaries:

- a. The salary to be paid to the Secretary/Treasurer for conducting his duties will be **\$.25** per bowler per night.
- b. No salaries will be paid to the Secretary/Treasurer until he has furnished to the Secretary of the South Jersey Bowling Association the Final Average Sheet.

Article 5 - League Funds:

- a. An account shall be opened in the name of the League, with the bowling center by the Secretary/Treasurer, in which funds will be deposited weekly.
- b. Withdrawals from the account shall be made only with the joint knowledge of at least two (2) authorized officers of the League.

Article 6 - Prizes:

- a. Prize money will be paid at the end of the season to each team based solely on the number of games won per half. The prize money per game will be calculated as follows:

- 1) Prize money from weekly dues - actual per half
- 2) Subtract: Banquet fees - actual per half
- 3) Subtract: Secretary/Treasurer's salary per Article 4a above.
- 4) Subtract: Individual & Team Awards as follows:

*** Each Half**

Individual High Avg	\$ 50
Individual High Series	\$ 50
Individual High Game	\$ 50
Team High Game Scratch	\$ 100
Team High Series Scratch	\$ 100
Team High Game Handicap	\$ 100
Team High Series Handicap	\$ 100
1 st Place Team after week 13	\$ 100
2 nd Place Team after week 13	\$ 50

*** End of Season**

Runner Ups	\$ 300
League Champions	\$ 500

*****NOTE - If a team wins both halves, they receive League Champions money only. The 2 teams that were Runner-Ups for each half will bowl in a roll-off in week 33 to determine Runner-up money. If the same team is runner-up in both halves, no roll-off is needed and this team receives the runner-up money**

- 5) Divide the sum of 1) through 4) above, by the total number of wins for each half.
- b. To qualify for individual awards, a bowler must have bowled in 2/3 of the scheduled games. Substitutes are not eligible.
- c. A bowler or team can qualify for only one (1) special award for High Series or Game **per half**.
- d. High Average (Team & Individual) are Achievement awards and as such, do not apply to Article 5c above.

Article 7 - Entering Averages:

- a. An individual's average from the last week of the previous year will be used for the first 9 games bowled in the new season. Once the 9th game is complete (or the week after the 9th game is completed) a new average will be calculated for going forward.
- b. A NEW bowler's average will be established after bowling three (3) games in league play. Handicap will be determined after the completion of the three (3) games rolled.
Note - a new bowler is anyone who did not have an established average at Bowlero-Cherry Hill, last year.

Article 8 - Handicap:

Handicap will be calculated as 85% of the difference between the 2 competing team's total averages for the 4 bowlers participating for that game/week.

Article 9 - Team Roster:

- a. Captains will turn in a roster of team members to the Secretary/Treasurer prior to the start of the schedule. Team rosters will be limited to seven (7) players. Any roster change must be reported to the League Secretary or President twenty-four (24) hours prior to the time the new member bowls.
- b. New members cannot be added to the team's roster after the completion of the 26th scheduled night of bowling.

Article 10 - Substitutes

- a. The league Secretary will maintain a list of roving subs. No sub may bowl for more than one team on any regularly scheduled bowling night.
- b. Any individual whose name appears on a team roster within this League will bowl for only that team.
- c. No substitute bowler will be allowed to bowl in any playoff match (occurring the last 3 weeks of each half). A substitute can bowl in the last 3 weeks of each half if it is for a NON playoff matchup. This rule shall not apply if a bowler is added to a roster because of extended illness or a rostered player dropping out of the league and being removed from a roster. However, a new roster bowler must have an established average (3 games) prior to the last 3 weeks of the half.

Article 11 - Legal Lineup:

- d. Two (2) bowlers from a team's current roster must be present no later than the completion of the fifth (5th) frame by both teams of each game to constitute a legal lineup. A pre-bowl is considered a present bowler. If a team does not have 4 bowlers on their roster, the vacant bowler/s is considered a present bowler. If this condition is not met, the game is forfeited.
- e. Bowlers appearing on a team roster are not substitutes. Therefore, they may bowl during any scheduled non-playoff match (i.e. knockdowns). To qualify to bowl a 1st half playoff match, a bowler must have a minimum of 6 games bowled. For a bowler to qualify for a 2nd half playoff match, a bowler must have either a minimum of 6 games bowled for the 2nd half OR has bowled at least a total of 12 games throughout the entire season.

Article 12 - Forfeitures & Blind Team:

- a. When a game is declared forfeited, or your team is bowling a Blind Team, the team present shall bowl as though the game was actually contested by completing each team frame on one lane before starting the next frame on the adjoining lane.
- b. For forfeitures, points will be awarded to the team bowling only if they exceed 80% of their team average each game (including total pins).
- c. When bowling against a blind team, points will be awarded to the team bowling only if they exceed 90% of their team average each game (including total pins).

Article 13 - Absentee and Vacancy Scores:

- a. Absentee scores shall be allowed when a team has a legal lineup, but less than a full lineup, at the start of any game in a series. The absentee score shall be the absent member's average less 10% of the average. When there are 5-7 members on a team's roster, the absentee score of the absent member with the most games bowled shall be used. If two (2) absentee scores are needed, the average of the absentees with the highest number of games bowled shall be used. If the absent members have bowled the same number of games, then the higher averages of the team members shall be used.
- b. When a team has less than 4 players on its roster for a full lineup, a vacancy score of one hundred fifty (150) shall be used. Such scores shall be the basis for the handicap.

Article 14 - Tardy Players:

- a. A bowler who arrives late may enter the game (Forfeit pending - see Article 11) provided five (5) frames have not been completed. After the 5th frame an appropriate absentee score is to be used.
- b. A frame shall be considered complete when the bowler in the anchor position on each team has completed the frame.

Article 15 - Position Standings:

Position standings shall be determined on a point basis, with one (1) point awarded for each game won and one (1) point for the high team series in each match. (4 points total per week)

In the event of a points tie for in season standings, knockdown positions, and playoff positions, total handicap pins will determine position rankings.

Article 16 - Playoffs:

- a. Teams bowl the first 13 weeks of each half to determine the top eight (8) teams. At the end of week 13, the 1st and 2nd place teams will be determined for additional prize money mentioned above in Article 6a.
- b. In weeks 14, 15, & 16, of each half, teams 9 & below (plus teams eliminated during the playoffs) are bowling only for prize money/wins.
- c. Total pins for three (3) games will determine winning a roll-off match, not by wins & losses. Four (4) points will be counted for prize money purposes.
 - In the event a playoff match is tied (total pins) at the end of the 3rd game - a 10th Frame roll-off will take place to determine the winner. Handicap will be 1/10 of the match-ups handicap score.
- d. Roll-off format:

Weeks 14/30 - Week 1 of playoffs (No re-seeding after this);

1 vs 8
2 vs 7
3 vs 6
4 vs 5

Weeks 15/31 - Week 2 of playoffs:

Lowest Seed vs Highest Seed
2nd Lowest Seed vs 3rd Lowest Seed

Weeks 16/32 - Week 3 of playoffs (Half Championship)

The 2 winners from week 2 of playoffs

Article 17 - Pre-Bowling

- a. League bowlers are eligible to pre-bowl an unlimited number of times where situations require it
- b. Playoff games are eligible to be pre-bowled.
- c. Pre-bowlers are considered present under Article 11 (Legal Lineup).
- d. At the request of Bowlero, Pre-bowling must be scheduled ahead of time. If you are pre-bowling after bowling on Thursday, a league officer should be notified

League Officers	NAME	Phone
President	_____	_____
Vice President	_____	_____
Secretary/Treasurer	_____	_____